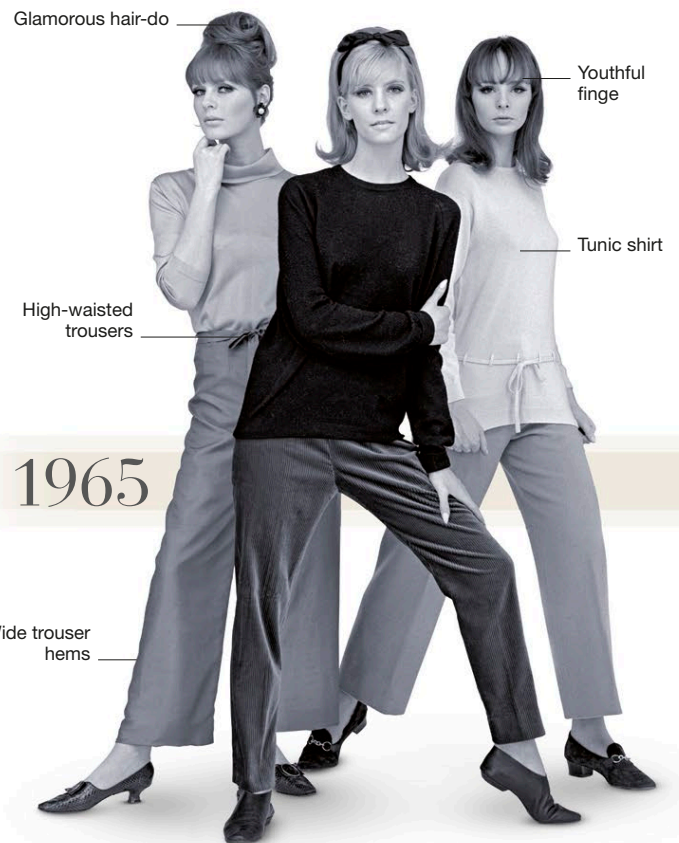


1964–1979

WOMEN WEAR THE TROUSERS

Stemming from the unisex fashions by futuristic designers such as Pierre Cardin and André Courrèges, fashionable women began wearing trousers in the 1960s and 70s. The sexual revolution and “women’s lib” meant that women were taking greater strides to enter the workforce, and as a result they borrowed more from men’s fashion. French designer Yves Saint Laurent (YSL) first created his sleek but controversial *Le Smoking* tuxedo suit for women in 1966, and continued to create androgynous styles each season. The look slowly became more widely accepted as an alternative to skirts and dresses. In 1971 YSL was inspired by 1940s clothing, incorporating this look into trouser suits and jump suits alike. Other designers quickly followed his example. The hippie flower power movement brought in faded denim jeans with wide hems, and the advent of disco encouraged sleek, figure-hugging suits with wide, flared trousers for both men and women.



1965

Tapered to flares From the outset, trousers were worn by younger women as a part of the growing youth culture. This group from 1965 shows the variety of styles. As the decade progressed, trousers evolved, including more fitted styles and more flared pairs.

AND MEN WEAR THE HEELS

Starting in 1967 designers began to bring back the platform shoe for both men and women, a look that had last been popular in the 1940s. British musical performers such as Elton John and David Bowie quickly adopted the look as a part of a new “male peacock” and psychedelic movement in men’s fashion. The examples here are of modest leather styles and heel height, but some platforms were as high as 15–18cm (6–7in) and made of wildly imaginative materials and textures such as cork, textured fabric, rope, and even leather-covered plastics or wood. Platform shoes and boots matched well with a pair of flares.

Platforms teamed with flares



Men's 1970s leather platform shoes

Cotton jacket in primary colours



1970

Slight flare

Nylon jersey crêpe

The acid test Bright colours and simple motifs bridged the gap between 1960s and 70s design. Marimekko, a Finnish design firm, led the way by creating bold floral prints similar to this stylized daisy-print jacket with acid-yellow trousers.

Belted tunic blouse

Long sleeves

1973



Machine embroidery

Matching trousers

Floral motif British designer Janice Wainwright created this black trouser suit embroidered with floral art deco motifs – a typical detail of her work from this period. She continued to focus on simple silver-thread embroidery through the 1970s.